

Ayush Jain, 30

Company: **Kotak Mahindra**

Position: **Trainee (wealth management)**

Salary: **Rs 15,000 and above**

Family: **Seven members**

How many trainees were sacked: 4 of 10

Three months back, this business administration graduate from University of Indiana, US, thought he was one of the luckiest guys to have returned to India and clinched an offer from a leading bank. Not any

VIKRAM SHARMA



"HNIs disappeared and I could not get meetings to generate business."

longer. He was told to put in his resignation on October 31, with three others. "It was a rude shattering of a dream," says Ayush. "Buoyed by the increasing presence of high net-worth individuals in India, I was looking forward to a career in this lucrative line." But within three months of working, the ominous signs made their tell-tale presence felt. He is looking to set up a franchisee outlet of a US-based restaurant. "If my business picks up, I will carry it further. Nothing like being your own master."

by **Nivedita Mukherjee**

daily-wage jobs by some estimates.

It's worse in textiles and garments. Rajinder Gupta, Trident chairman, says: "The pipeline of orders has almost dried up. The scenario demands a political call from the government if jobs are to be saved." The Government has only messed up the scene. S.P. Oswal, chairman, Vardhman Group, explains this rather eloquently: "Thanks to votebank politics, the Government hiked the MSP for cotton from Rs 1,950 to Rs 2,800 per quintal. The 40 per cent hike came when international prices crashed by 40 per cent. Net result: Indian products are expensive and uncompetitive."

Hospitality and tourism, big employers again, were reporting 40 per cent growth an-

Real Estate

Five years of stupendous growth in construction and valuation had made billionaires out of millionaires. But thanks to the credit crunch, unreal valuations have crashed, exposing hollow business plans and the bubble underneath. The downturn may drag many other sectors such as manufacturing, finance with it.

“We are in grave danger. India needs a \$500-billion stimulus package like China.” RAJEEV TALWAR, *Group Executive Director, DLF*



78%

OF THE PLANNED HIRING HAS BEEN CANCELLED. WORSE, LAYOFFS ARE A DAILY ROUTINE.

BANDEEP SINGH